



Sure Access to Success

TANGIBLE / INTANGIBLE VERBS

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ACTION VERBS

- **Tangible Verbs** – Sing, Dance, Eat etc.
(We can experience through our 5 senses)
- **Intangible / Perception / Stative Verbs** –
Love, Know, Understand, Agree etc.

Intangible / Perception / Stative Verbs

Stative verbs describe a state rather than an action. They are **not usually used** in the continuous form (**ing-Form**).

I don't know the answer. ~~I'm not knowing the answer.~~

She really likes you. ~~She's really liking you.~~

He seems happy at the moment. ~~He's seeming happy at the moment.~~



Examples **TANGIBLE VERBS**

Intangible / Perception / Stative Verbs

Stative verbs often relate to:

- **thoughts and opinions:**

agree, believe, doubt, guess, imagine, know, mean, recognise, remember, suspect, think, understand

- **feelings and emotions:**

dislike, hate, like, love, prefer, want, wish, respect

- **senses and perceptions:**

appear, be, feel, hear, look, see, seem, smell, taste

- **possession and measurement:**

belong, have, measure, own, possess, weigh.

Some verbs are Tangible or Intangible depending on the Context

- *I think it's a good idea. (intangible)*
Wait a moment! I'm thinking. (tangible)
- The first sentence expresses an opinion. It is a mental state, so we use present simple.
- In the second example the speaker is actively processing thoughts about something. It is an action in progress, so we use present continuous.

Some verbs are Tangible or Intangible depending on the Context

- **Have***
- *I have an old car.* (state – possession)
I'm having a quick break. (action – having a break is an activity)
Don't call him now. He is having breakfast. (eat)
- **see**
- *Do you see any problems with that?* (state – opinion)
We're seeing Jim tomorrow afternoon. (action – we're meeting him)
Sheela is seeing a doctor. (consulting)
Meera is seeing a doctor. (dating) / consulting?

Some verbs are Tangible or Intangible depending on the Context

be

- *He is so interesting!* (state – his permanent quality)
He is being very unhelpful. (action – he is behaving this way)
He is very unhelpful.

taste

- *This coffee tastes delicious.* (state – our perception of the coffee)
The chef is tasting the soup. (action – tasting the soup is an activity)